

Running an event with EventScore

Setting up beforehand, running the night itself, and getting the results out cleanly.

- Setup takes about twenty minutes, done in advance
- Judges need a phone and nothing else
- Printable results at the end

Do the setup days ahead, not on the night. Rounds, contestants and judges all take time and none of it needs to happen at the venue. On the night you should only be sending links and watching progress.

How it fits together

Five things, each inside the one before it. Understanding this makes the rest obvious.

Piece	What it is
Event	The whole competition. Has a name, a date, and a six-character code judges can use.
Round	A stage of the competition. Each says how many contestants go through to the next.
Category	A thing judges mark in that round, out of a maximum you set. Rounds can have completely different categories.
Contestant	Somebody competing. Name, entry number, optional photograph and description.
Judge	Somebody scoring. Gets a personal link, a QR code and a PIN.

Setting up

1. Create the event

Sign in and choose **New event**. Name, date and venue, plus **how many winners** you are awarding. Three is usual. The podium always shows the top three; if you award more, the rest appear in the ranked list

underneath.

2. Add the rounds

For each round, give it a name and choose what happens after it: either a number of contestants go through, or it ends the event. Every event needs exactly one round that ends it.

Straight after saving a round you land on its categories page, because a round without categories cannot be scored. The event page warns you if any round is still missing them.

3. Say what gets marked

Add a category for each thing judges score in that round, with the highest mark they can give. Poise out of 10, Talent out of 20, whatever suits. The page shows the maximum one judge can award in that round, which is the number organisers most often get wrong on paper.

Rounds are kept separate. A round scored out of 50 does not swamp one scored out of 30. Each round is compared on its own terms before anyone advances, and every round's marks are kept and shown in the final table.

4. Add contestants

Name, entry number, and optionally a photograph and a short description. Photographs help enormously on the night, especially with a large field. The description appears to judges while they score, which is useful for something like a discipline or a home town.

Entry numbers matter more than they look: they are what judges tap to jump to somebody, and they decide the order in the list.

5. Add judges

Each judge gets a personal link, a QR code and a four-digit PIN. Send the link one way and the PIN another, so neither alone is enough to get in.

The judge at the top of the list is the **head judge**, who settles any tie the panel cannot. Use the arrows to change the order, or Make head judge to move somebody straight to the top.

6. Check the settings

Setting	What it controls
Your logo	Shown to you, to judges while they mark, and on the results.
Judge comments	Not asked for, optional, or required on every contestant.
Moving between rounds	Whether everyone waits for the full panel, or judges move on independently. Waiting is safer.
Winners	How many places you award. The podium shows three regardless.
Show marks	Whether scores appear beside names on the results.
Delete after	Days after the event date when everything is removed automatically.

On the night

- 1 **Send the links.** QR codes are quickest if the judges are all in the room. Have the PINs ready to read out.
- 2 **Get everyone signed in early,** before the audience arrives. The network is quiet then and problems are easy to fix.
- 3 **Open the live console** on your laptop. Tap Run the event on the event page.
- 4 **Watch them score.** Standings build as judges submit and are marked provisional until everyone is in.
- 5 **Look at the advance line** drawn across the table. It shows who is through on current marks.
- 6 **The round closes itself** when the last judge submits, and the next one opens.
- 7 **At the end,** open the results for the rankings, or Stage mode to put the podium on a projector.

The live console

This is the screen to keep open all evening. It shows each judge as submitted or still going, the standings so far, and how many judges those standings are based on.

Nobody moves on until every judge submits. That is deliberate: it means the shortlist is always built from the full panel and no judge is ever asked to re-score somebody. If a judge genuinely cannot finish, use **Judge cannot finish** to close the round without them. Their partial marks do not count, and the decision is printed on the results.

If two contestants tie

When a tie sits at a place that matters, the judges are automatically asked to choose between the tied contestants. They see photographs but no scores.

You watch it on the live console and can see who has not voted yet. One judge decides alone; two who disagree defer to the head judge; three or more go by majority. If a judge has left, **A judge cannot vote** settles it by entry number instead.

Results

Where	What it gives you
Results	The podium plus every contestant ranked, showing each round's marks and a grand total.
Stage mode	Full screen for a projector. First place tallest in the middle, revealed in order.
Export PDF	Cover page, the result, every round in full, and any judge comments. Print or save.

Export before you announce. Once you have the PDF, the result exists outside the app. It takes thirty seconds and it is the difference between a disagreement and a disaster.

Things that go wrong

Problem	What to do
A judge cannot sign in	Check they are using the current link. Read their PIN from the Judges page. Eight wrong attempts locks them out for fifteen minutes.
A judge's phone died	Sign in on another device with the same link and PIN. Saved marks are on the server, not the phone.
A judge has left the venue	Judge cannot finish on the live console closes the round without them.
The round will not advance	Somebody has not submitted. The live console names them.
A judge submitted a wrong mark	It cannot be changed once submitted. Note it and decide whether to correct the record afterwards.
The venue wifi is failing	Judges can keep marking; their phones hold the marks and send them when it returns. If it stays down, fall back to paper.
A contestant withdraws	Remove them before the round opens. Once judges are scoring, the line-up is frozen.
The results look wrong	Check the live console for how many judges are counted. Standings only include judges who have submitted.

Your responsibilities

You are the data controller for everything you upload. In plain terms, the contestants' and judges' information is yours rather than ours, and the obligations that come with it are yours too.

What	What it means for you
Consent	Everyone whose name or photograph you upload must have agreed to it. There is a notice you can hand out in your account.
Ages	EventScore is for competitions where every contestant and judge is 18 or over.
Judge access	Links and PINs are yours to distribute and revoke. Remove a judge who no longer needs access.
Deletion	Event data is deleted automatically after the retention period in your settings. You can shorten it or delete an event outright.
Requests	If a contestant asks to see or remove their information, that request comes to you.

EventScore does not read your event data. The administrative tools have no access to event names, contestants or scores, and the database itself refuses those requests.

Checklists

A week before

- Event created with rounds, categories and contestants
- Every round has at least one category
- One round marked as the one that ends the event
- Judges added and the order set, head judge at the top
- Settings checked, especially the number of winners
- A dummy run through one round to see how it behaves

The day before

- Contestant list matches the final entries
- Photographs uploaded for anyone who has one
- Judge links and PINs ready to send
- Venue wifi tested on a phone, standing where the judges will sit
- Signed in yourself on the device you will use on the night
- Paper scorecards printed as a fallback

On the night

- Every judge signed in before the audience arrives
- Every judge has scored one test contestant to prove it works
- Live console open where you can see it
- Event code written down in case a link fails
- Results exported before the announcement

Print the paper scorecards. Venue wifi fails, and it has nothing to do with this app. A room that is fine at five o'clock is struggling at eight, because three hundred people have arrived with phones. Ten minutes of printing is the cheapest insurance you will buy.